



DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC SAFETY GEORGIA STATE PATROL

PURSUIT CRITIQUE

TROOPER NAME – SGT Doug Shamblin #485

Work Assignment: Troop/Division - A; Post/Unit – 38 - Rome

INCIDENT REPORT # DPS00147501

Related Crash Reports: C000924530 ; _____ ; _____

P.I.T. Involved: No

S.C.R.T. Involved: No

Special Investigations Unit Involved: No

Use of Force Involved: Yes

MEETING

1. Document the date, time and location of the pursuit critique meeting with the involved trooper.

Date: 3/13/2024

Time: 1432 Hours

Location: Via Conference Call

2. List all personnel present at the meeting by name and rank. Include the trooper, an NCO in whose territory the pursuit was terminated, and the trooper's immediate supervisor.

Personnel present: Lieutenant Tim Nichols #36, SFC Chris Harris #753 and SGT Doug Shamblin #485

INITIATION

1. Provide the date and time the trooper became involved in the pursuit.

Date: 2/14/2024

Time: 1724 Hours

2. Explain the circumstances that led to the trooper's involvement in the pursuit.

On 2/14/2024, at approximately 1724 hours, SGT Shamblin was patrolling northbound on GA 1 in Chattooga County when he observed a blue motorcycle traveling south that was following another vehicle extremely close and there was no tag visible on the motorcycle. When SGT Shamblin turned around in order to perform a traffic stop, the violator made a right turn onto Wildlife Lake Road. As SGT Shamblin turned onto Wildlife Lake Road, the violator failed to stop and a pursuit ensued.

3. If trooper's involvement was the result of a request from another agency, provide details regarding the request.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

4. List the number and identity of other agencies and officers involved in the pursuit.

☒ N/A If needed, list:

5. If other occupants were in the patrol vehicle, identify them and state their reason for being in the vehicle.

☒ N/A If Yes, list:

6. Did the trooper take appropriate safety precautions?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

7. Did the trooper eliminate distractions such as FM radio noise?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

COMMUNICATION

1. If the reporting trooper initiated the pursuit by means of observing a violation and attempting a traffic stop, explain the communication that took place between the trooper and the CEO.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: SGT Shamblin contacted the Troop A Communications Center by radio and advised them that he was in a pursuit. SGT Shamblin provided his location, direction of travel and description of the motorcycle. Senior Dispatcher Smith received this information and created a CAD call for the pursuit.

2. Did the trooper relay pertinent information to the CEO including:

- Location and direction of travel.
- Description of the pursued vehicle.
- Number and description of occupants.
- Information regarding the use of firearms, threat of force, or other hazard.
- Options for terminating the pursuit.
- Observed danger to public safety.
- Any need for assistance.

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

3. Explain any communication that took place between the CEO and other law enforcement agencies or officers in the area.

☐ N/A Explain: Once the pursuit initiated, Senior Dispatcher Smith cleared the radio for emergency traffic. However, the pursuit ended before a broadcast could be given out to other Troop A Troopers. Dispatcher Carden contacted the Chattooga County 911 Center to advise them of the pursuit and to request assistance.

4. If the reporting trooper became involved in the pursuit at the request of another agency, explain any communication that took place between the trooper and another officer of the requesting agency. Give details of communication between the CEO and the requesting agency regarding the location, direction of travel, nature of the offense, any pending warrants, and details of erratic driving behavior illustrating the potential danger to the public if the suspect is not immediately apprehended.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

5. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☐ Yes ☒ No If no, explain: After providing the initial information of his location, direction of travel and a description of the vehicle, the pursuit ended before SGT Shamblin could transmit any other information.

6. At the conclusion of the pursuit, did the trooper advise the CEO immediately, so other units would be familiar with the location to offer assistance, or slow in an effort to reduce the likelihood of further risk of injury to either a trooper or a member of the general public?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

7. Discuss any needed areas of improvement with the CEO.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

PURSUIT

1. Describe the route the pursuit traveled, its duration and distance.

Describe: The pursuit initiated on Wildlife Lake Road and traveled south approximately one mile before the violator crashed his vehicle. The pursuit lasted approximately 51 seconds.

2. Were the trooper's actions during the pursuit objectively reasonable?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

3. If the pursuit traveled into another post's territory, explain whether the initiating trooper yielded to a trooper whose territory the pursuit was in.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

4. If the initiating trooper yielded the primary position to another unit, explain whether he proceeded to the termination point of the pursuit to provide guidance and information for the arrest of the violator.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

5. Explain if there were any factors during the pursuit that indicated the possible commission of a felony.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: The violator's actions during the pursuit support a charge of Felony Fleeing and Attempting to Elude.

6. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☐ Yes

☒ No

If no, explain: Due to the shortness of the pursuit, SGT Shamblin was unable to provide any information before the pursuit concluded.

7. Did the trooper practice commentator driving?

☐ Yes

☒ No

If no, explain: After notifying the Communications Center of the pursuit, SGT Shamblin was unable to commentate any information before the violator crashed.

8. Did the trooper remain calm and professional during the pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

DRIVING SKILLS

1. Did the trooper use due caution when operating his vehicle during the pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. Were the driving skills/techniques initiated appropriately?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during the pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

4. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during termination?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

5. Did the trooper appear to experience adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or any other internal/external factors?

☐ No

If Yes, explain: SGT Shamblin stated he experienced a slight adrenalin rush during the pursuit.

6. Did the trooper get into the danger zone due to adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or other factors?

☒ No

If Yes, explain:

EQUIPMENT

1. Were the blue lights and siren in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. If the patrol car was equipped with wig-wag headlights, were they in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. Was the in-car camera working properly?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

4. Was the trooper's microphone working properly?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

TERMINATION

1. Did the trooper continue the pursuit to a conclusion? If not, explain the reasons.

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. Was there a good probability of the suspect's arrest at a later time because of positive identification?

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

3. Articulate attempts taken by the trooper to utilize pursuit termination techniques, such as tire deflating devices, roadblocks, P.I.T. maneuver, and trooper discretion.

☒ N/A

Explain:

4. Expound on safety precautions utilized by the trooper during and after the pursuit.

☐ N/A

Explain: SGT Shamblin utilized all of his emergency equipment and exercised due caution throughout the pursuit. SGT Shamblin didn't take any unnecessary risks while operating his vehicle or as he took the suspect into custody.

5. Articulate the existing traffic conditions during the pursuit, realizing the conditions may differ at various times during the pursuit.

Explain: The pursuit occurred during daytime hours with clear skies and a dry road surface. The traffic conditions at the time of the pursuit would be described as light.

6. Address whether there are any conditions that would create additional danger to the public by continuing the pursuit.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

7. Address whether there were any conditions that necessitated the pursuit being brought to an immediate conclusion and describe the conditions.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

8. Establish whether the violator was an immediate threat to the trooper, the public or themselves.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: The violator had no intentions of stopping for law enforcement. He operated his vehicle at excessive speeds while driving on the wrong side of the road. The violator had no regard for his own safety or the safety of SGT Shamblin.

9. Outline whether the use of deadly force was justified and if so, why it was justified.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

10. Establish whether the method of termination was reasonable based on the facts gathered during the pursuit, and state those facts.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

11. If there were any injuries, state who received them, the type and severity.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: The suspect complained of minor injuries as a result of the crash. SGT Shamblin transported the violator to the the emergency room at Atrium Hospital in Trion to be medically cleared before being booked into the Chattooga County Jail.

12. If there was a fatality, provide basic facts surrounding the circumstances.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

13. Address any damage to vehicles.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: The violator's vehicle sustained disabling damage as a result of the crash.

TROOPER'S ABILITIES AND EXPERIENCE

1. Prior pursuits (compare if appropriate).

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: SGT Shamblin has been involved in numerous pursuits during his career as a Georgia State Trooper.

2. Past use of techniques and high speed driving.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: SGT Shamblin has received E.V.O.C. and Advanced E.V.O.C. Training.

ISSUES ADDRESSED

1. Positives.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: SGT Shamblin operated his vehicle in a responsible manner during the pursuit and didn't take any unnecessary risks while taking the suspect into custody.

2. Areas for improvement.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

3. Other considerations.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: After the suspect crashed his vehicle, he attempted to flee on foot. During the foot pursuit, SGT Shamblin drew and pointed his departmental issued Taser at the suspect. A Use of Force Report was completed.

RESPONSE FROM TROOPER OR SUPERVISOR

1. Allow trooper and supervisor an opportunity to respond or add comments.



N/A

If Yes, explain:

CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN

1. Describe any corrective action taken as a result of the trooper's actions during the pursuit.



N/A

If Yes, explain: SGT Shamblin was counseled for his unprofessional language while giving the violator verbal commands after fleeing the scene.

Lt. T. L. Nichols #36
Reviewing Officer

Lt. T. L. Nichols #36

3/13/2024

Date